



Williamsburg-James City County Public Schools

Minutes from Tuesday, August 18, 2026

Regular Meeting

Berkeley Middle School, 1118 Ironbound Road, Williamsburg, VA

**Call to Order & Closed Session beginning at 6:00 p.m. in Room 200,
followed by the Open Session at 6:30 p.m. in the Auditorium**

1. Meeting Opening

1.01 Call to Order

The meeting was called to order at 5:58 p.m.

1.02 The Roll is Taken

Present were Daniel R. Cavazos, M.D.; Amy Chen, M.A.T.; Ty Hodges; Michael T. Hosang, J.D.; Kimberley M. Hundley, M.Ed.; and Randy J. Riffle (Vice Chair). Also present were Daniel F. Keever, Ph.D., Superintendent; Beth Allar, Clerk of the Board; staff, press & the public. Andrea M. Donnor was absent.

2. Closed Session(s)

2.01 Personnel Issues

A motion was made that the Williamsburg-James City County School Board convene in closed session for review and discussion of appointments, change in status, leaves of absence, separations, academic and athletic stipends; and, associated actions, pursuant to the personnel exception at § 2.2-3711(A)(1) of the Code of Virginia.

Moved by: Amy Chen, M.A.T.; seconded by: Ty Hodges

Aye: Daniel R. Cavazos, M.D., Amy Chen, M.A.T., Ty Hodges, Michael T. Hosang, J.D., Kimberley M. Hundley, M.Ed., and Randy J. Riffle

The board recessed at 6:07 p.m.

Motion Carries 6-0

3. Regular Meeting

3.01 Chair Reconvenes the Meeting

The meeting reconvened at 6:30 p.m.

3.02 Board Certifies Closed Session(s)

Ms. Chen certified, that to the best of each member's knowledge, the Williamsburg-James City County School Board, while in closed session, discussed only public business matters lawfully exempted from open meeting requirements as stated in Virginia Law and that only such public matters as were identified in the motion convening the closed meeting were heard, discussed or considered.

Moved by: Amy Chen, M.A.T.; seconded by: Kimberley M. Hundley, M.Ed.

Aye: Daniel R. Cavazos, M.D., Amy Chen, M.A.T., Ty Hodges, Michael T. Hosang, J.D., Kimberley M. Hundley, M.Ed., and Randy J. Riffle

Motion Carries 6-0

3.03 Approval of the Agenda

A motion was made to approve the agenda as presented.

Moved by: Michael T. Hosang, J.D.; seconded by: Ty Hodges

Aye: Daniel R. Cavazos, M.D., Amy Chen, M.A.T., Ty Hodges, Michael T. Hosang, J.D., Kimberley M. Hundley, M.Ed., and Randy J. Riffle

Motion Carries 6-0

3.04 Pledge of Allegiance

Mr. Hosang led the pledge.

3.05 Minute of Silence

4. Announcements/Superintendent's Report

4.01 Announcements/Superintendent's Report

Dr. Keever reported on the following:

- **Superintendent Advisory Councils & School Board Citizen Advisory Committees**
 - Connect and engage with WJCC Schools through Superintendent and School Board Advisory Councils. Each team works together to advance student achievement and division goals through the unique lens of their group.
 - Complete the application on the website by August 28 to express interest in serving on one of three Superintendent Advisory Councils:
 - Family Advisory Council
 - Community Advisory Council
 - Business Advisory Council
 - Applications are accepted now through September 3 for two School Board Councils: Career Ready Advisory and Special Education Advisory.
- **Launch**
 - Last week, nearly 150 new instructional staff members were welcomed to team WJCC
 - Appreciate their energy and excitement – and incredibly thankful they have chosen to have a career with WJCC
- **WJCC Back to School Kickoff**
 - Yesterday, WJCC hosted two kickoff sessions, bringing together the instructional team at the secondary and elementary levels to celebrate the new school year
 - In the coming weeks – and woven in all the work ahead – the community will hear about the WJCC Profile of an Empowered Learner
 - Six talented students helped share the profile
 - Also welcomed AJ Juliani, an instructional leader who challenged WJCC to strive for meaningful, relevant connections with each student – helping them become empowered learners
- **Community Outreach: 2nd Sunday & Ft. Eustis**
 - The team has been excited to make connections with the community, recently at Second Sunday in Williamsburg
 - Also connected with military families at the back-to-school event at Ft. Eustis
 - Excited to see the community's excitement for WJCC schools and readiness for the new school year
- **Open Houses**
 - High school open houses are underway
 - Middle schools are tomorrow, 4-6 p.m.
 - Elementary schools are on Thursday, 4-6 p.m.

- **First Day of School**
 - Excitement culminates in the first day
 - Can't wait to see students back in the building for the new school year
 - Monday, Aug. 24
 - Acknowledged that buses may run late the first few days, but doing best to ensure they are on-time and students are in school for learning

5. Citizens' Comments

5.01 Public Comment

The following speakers addressed the board, and the themes of their comments are noted below:

- Melissa Townsend – Rezoning
- Jamila Walker -Special Education (new initiative)
- Bryon Smith – Rezoning
- Victoria Vincench – Redistricting
- Suzanne Cruz - Uniting children / grouping
- Susan Franz – Heritage
- Drew Beauchamp - Military affected by rezoning
- Andrew Huckabee - Redistricting woes
- Joe Caterine - Rename James Blair Middle School
- Brian Lawrence - Redistricting August map impact on Ford's Colony elementary kids / Celebrate diversity
- Robert Ferreira - School Apps, Centralized Scheduling, Laptop Usage

6. Consent Agenda

A motion was made to approve the consent agenda as presented, which consisted of the following items: 6.01 Approval of Financial Report and Monthly Bills & Payroll - July 2026; 6.02 Approval of Resolution R-18-26, National Hispanic Heritage Month; 6.03 Approval of Release from Compulsory Attendance, Case #R2627-03; and 6.04 Approval of Release from Compulsory Attendance, Case #R2627-04.

Moved by: Amy Chen, M.A.T.; seconded by: Kimberley M. Hundley, M.Ed.

Aye: Daniel R. Cavazos, M.D., Amy Chen, M.A.T., Ty Hodges, Michael T. Hosang, J.D., Kimberley M. Hundley, M.Ed., and Randy J. Riffle

Motion Carries 6-0

7. Action Items

7.01 Approval of Personnel Actions

A motion was made to approve the Personnel Actions as presented.

Moved by: Ty Hodges; seconded by: Daniel R. Cavazos, M.D.

Aye: Daniel R. Cavazos, M.D., Amy Chen, M.A.T., Ty Hodges, Michael T. Hosang, J.D., Kimberley M. Hundley, M.Ed., and Randy J. Riffle

Motion Carries 6-0

7.02 Approval of Minutes from the Work Session on 8/4/26

A motion was made to approve the minutes from the Work Session on 8/4/26 as presented.

Moved by: Kimberley M. Hundley, M.Ed.; seconded by: Ty Hodges

Aye: Daniel R. Cavazos, M.D., Amy Chen, M.A.T., Ty Hodges, Kimberley M. Hundley, M.Ed., and Randy J. Riffle

Abstain: Michael T. Hosang, J.D.

Motion Carries 5-0

7.03 Approval of Amendment to FY27 Grants Fund Budget

A motion was made to approve the amendment to the FY27 Grants Fund Budget to \$7,200,000.

Moved by: Michael T. Hosang, J.D.; seconded by: Amy Chen, M.A.T.

Aye: Daniel R. Cavazos, M.D., Amy Chen, M.A.T., Ty Hodges, Michael T. Hosang, J.D., Kimberley M. Hundley, M.Ed., and Randy J. Riffle

Motion Carries 6-0

7.04 Approval of Fiscal Year 2028 Budget Calendar

A motion was made to approve the Fiscal Year 2028 budget calendar as presented.

Moved by: Ty Hodges; seconded by: Daniel R. Cavazos, M.D.

Aye: Daniel R. Cavazos, M.D., Amy Chen, M.A.T., Ty Hodges, Michael T. Hosang, J.D., Kimberley M. Hundley, M.Ed., and Randy J. Riffle

Motion Carries 6-0

7.05 Approval of Authorization to Permit City/County Use of School Buses

A motion was made to approve the authorization to permit use of school buses by the city and county for the 2026-2027 school year.

Moved by: Kimberley M. Hundley, M.Ed.; seconded by: Ty Hodges

Aye: Daniel R. Cavazos, M.D., Amy Chen, M.A.T., Ty Hodges, Michael T. Hosang, J.D., Kimberley M. Hundley, M.Ed., and Randy J. Riffle

Motion Carries 6-0

7.06 Approval of 2026-2027 Child Nutrition Services (CNS) Food and Consumables Purchase

A motion was made to approve the 2026-2027 Child Nutrition Services food and consumables purchase as presented.

Prior to the vote, Mr. Hosang asked for clarification on the contracts attached to the agenda item since they listed other school districts and not Williamsburg-James City County. Dr. Keever explained that they are cooperative contracts that WJCC generally uses to procure meals and child nutrition services purchases; other school divisions/entities have gone through procurement processes and there is cooperative language available in the contracts that allows WJCC to take advantage of them.

Moved by: Amy Chen, M.A.T.; seconded by: Kimberley M. Hundley, M.Ed.

Aye: Daniel R. Cavazos, M.D., Amy Chen, M.A.T., Ty Hodges, Michael T. Hosang, J.D., Kimberley M. Hundley, M.Ed., and Randy J. Riffle

Motion Carries 6-0

7.07 Approval of Award of Contract for Request for Proposal #20260882, Ten (10) Playgrounds for Bright Beginnings North and South Campuses

A motion was made to approve the award of contract for Request for Proposal #20260882, Ten (10) Playgrounds for Bright Beginnings North and South Campuses to Sparks@Play for a total cost not to exceed \$1.8 million.

Moved by: Kimberley M. Hundley, M.Ed.; seconded by: Michael T. Hosang, J.D.

Aye: Daniel R. Cavazos, M.D., Amy Chen, M.A.T., Ty Hodges, Michael T. Hosang, J.D., Kimberley M. Hundley, M.Ed., and Randy J. Riffle

Motion Carries 6-0

7.08 Approval of Award of Contract for Request for Proposal #20260900, Furnishings, Fixtures, and Equipment (FFE) for Bright Beginnings North and South Campuses

A motion was made to approve the award of contract for Request for Proposal #20260900, Furnishings, Fixtures, and Equipment (FFE) for Bright Beginnings North and South Campuses to Lakeshore and Ball Office for a total cost not to exceed \$1.3 million.

Moved by: Ty Hodges; seconded by: Kimberley M. Hundley, M.Ed.

Aye: Daniel R. Cavazos, M.D., Amy Chen, M.A.T., Ty Hodges, Michael T. Hosang, J.D., Kimberley M. Hundley, M.Ed., and Randy J. Riffle

Motion Carries 6-0

7.09 Approval of Request for a Permanent Easement at Toano Middle School of Real Property to Virginia Department of Environmental Quality

A motion was made to approve the request for granting a permanent easement at Toano Middle School, James City County Real Estate Tax Parcel No. 1240100051, to the Virginia Department of Environmental Quality as presented.

Moved by: Kimberley M. Hundley, M.Ed.; seconded by: Daniel R. Cavazos, M.D.

Aye: Daniel R. Cavazos, M.D., Amy Chen, M.A.T., Ty Hodges, Michael T. Hosang, J.D., Kimberley M. Hundley, M.Ed., and Randy J. Riffle

Motion Carries 6-0

7.10 Approval of Request for Permanent Easements at Clara Byrd Baker Elementary School of Real Property to James City County

A motion was made to approve the request for granting a permanent easement at James City County Real Estate Tax Parcel No. 4710100058, to James City County as presented.

Moved by: Amy Chen, M.A.T.; seconded by: Kimberley M. Hundley, M.Ed.

Aye: Daniel R. Cavazos, M.D., Amy Chen, M.A.T., Ty Hodges, Michael T. Hosang, J.D., Kimberley M. Hundley, M.Ed., and Randy J. Riffle

Motion Carries 6-0

7.11 Approval of Request for Permanent Easements at Norge Elementary School of Real Property to James City County

A motion was made to approve the request for granting a permanent easement at James City County Real Estate Tax Parcel No. 2320100035, to James City County as presented.

Moved by: Amy Chen, M.A.T.; seconded by: Michael T. Hosang, J.D.

Aye: Daniel R. Cavazos, M.D., Amy Chen, M.A.T., Ty Hodges, Michael T. Hosang, J.D., Kimberley M. Hundley, M.Ed., and Randy J. Riffle

Motion Carries 6-0

8. Board Matters/Requests

8.01 Board Members' Comments

Board members commented on the following:

- Coaches' Night – thanked everyone who came out and the coaches for what they do; shout-out to Karen Barefoot, the speaker that evening
- Training exercise held at the end of July to test emergency response; plea to all parents - if a situation arises, please heed instructions given by the school system
- Issue from vote at the last meeting regarding increase in funding received from the state - would have recommended going forward with projects first before anything else
- Redistricting
 - Thanked Ms. Wall for leading the redistricting committee - difficult issue to tackle, does it with great calmness in dealing with the committee and presenting information to the public
 - Can't say enough great things about how the committee was run
 - They are trying to do the best thing for the community

- The survey is closed, but they are open to hearing from the public as boundary lines are finalized and move into the transition and planning piece which is equally important
- Thanked community for continuing engagement, advocacy, and hard questions to consider
- Asked community for support and to remember they are also parents and neighbors and this will be successful if they can work together on it
- They all want to do what is best for children – it is why they are there
- Questions about grandfathering in rising juniors or seniors at their current schools; what staffing will look like as people move around; what resources will be available to students and staff members who are affected most by the realignment
- Requested that administration have a plan of action prepared alongside the maps to help provide board members and the community at-large a full picture of what the maps look like and how the division plans to support students, families and staff during the transition
- Welcomed new teachers last week – could feel the energy in the room; heartwarming
- Welcome back students and staff this coming Monday
- Reading – the most valuable skill educators will develop in students; has been debate on the question of how to teach children to read; shared history of teaching methods; noted phonics has been determined as the best approach; reiterated that WJCC has adopted Benchmark which is aligned with that concept/the science of reading
- RPEO and the 757 Give Back Committee hosting annual Back to School event, Saturday, 8/22, 10-1 p.m., Lafayette High School - serves hundreds of students and their families by providing backpacks, school supplies, meals, free haircuts and hairstyles, health and wellness resources, educational information, and connections to organizations that serve the community
- Proud to be a school board member for a division that respects, celebrates, and honors diverse backgrounds and heritages
- Thanked speakers for coming out to share experiences and suggestions
- Clarified when to reach out to school board members vs school administration

9. Meeting Schedule

9.01 Upcoming Events

Event / Date	Time / Location
Special Education Advisory Committee 9/9/2026	5:00 p.m. Rm. 108, School Board and Central Office 117 Ironbound Road, Williamsburg, VA
School Liaison Committee 9/11/2026	8:30 a.m. Rm. 300, School Board and Central Office Annex 117 Ironbound Road, Williamsburg, VA

9.02 Upcoming Meetings

Meeting / Date	Time / Location
Work Session & Action Items 9/1/2026	Call to Order & Closed Session at 4:00 p.m. Open Session at 4:30 p.m. Rm. 300, School Board and Central Office Annex 117 Ironbound Road, Williamsburg, VA

Regular Meeting 9/15/2026	Call to Order & Closed Session at 5:45 p.m. in Room 200 Open Session at 6:30 p.m. in the Auditorium Berkeley Middle School 1118 Ironbound Road, Williamsburg, VA
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10. Adjournment

10.01 Meeting Adjourns

The meeting adjourned at 7:29 p.m.

Beth Allar, Clerk of the Board

Andrea M. Donnor, Chair